

# Sea Turtle Conservation in Türkiye

Who protects loggerhead & green turtle nesting beaches along the Turkish coast — and how to reach them. Share freely; if you run one of these groups and want it on the Caretta Friends app, write to us.



**Sick, injured or dead turtle?** Call **DEKAMER** emergency +90 538 403 2501 · or 112.

## UNIVERSITY RESEARCH & RESCUE CENTERS

### DEKAMER — Sea Turtle Research & Rescue Center

UNIVERSITY

*Pamukkale University · Dalyan*

Türkiye's main research, rescue & rehabilitation center. İztuzu–Dalaman monitoring + national rescue hospital. Led by Prof. Dr. Yakup Kaska.

🌐 [dekamer.org.tr](http://dekamer.org.tr)

✉ [dekamerturkey@gmail.com](mailto:dekamerturkey@gmail.com)

☎ +90 252 289 00 77

**İztuzu · Dalaman · Ekincik · Fethiye**

### Mersin University Sea Turtle Center (DEKUYAM)

UNIVERSITY

*Mersin University*

Monitors green & loggerhead nesting along the Mersin / Çukurova coast; supports injured-turtle care.

🌐 [mersin.edu.tr](http://mersin.edu.tr) → DEKUYAM

☎ +90 324 361 00 01

**Kazanlı · Alata · Göksu Delta · Demirtaş**

### Çukurova University · Faculty of Fisheries

UNIVERSITY

*Çukurova University · Adana*

Research & monitoring on the Çukurova coast and İskenderun Gulf nesting beaches.

🌐 [suf.cu.edu.tr](http://suf.cu.edu.tr)

✉ [suf@cu.edu.tr](mailto:suf@cu.edu.tr)

☎ +90 322 338 60 84

**Yumurtalık · Samandağ**

### Pamukkale University — Patara & Fethiye teams

UNIVERSITY

*Pamukkale University*

Patara SEPA nest monitoring (Prof. Dr. Eyüp Başkale) and Fethiye-Göcek SEPA surveys (Öğr. Gör. Doğan Sözbilen).

🌐 [akbis.pau.edu.tr](http://akbis.pau.edu.tr) (Başkale)

🌐 [akbis.pau.edu.tr](http://akbis.pau.edu.tr) (Sözbilen)

**Patara · Fethiye / Çalış**

### ÇOMÜ DEKUM

UNIVERSITY

*Çanakkale Onsekiz Mart University*

Sea Turtle Research & Application Center — research and monitoring support.

🌐 [dekum.comu.edu.tr](http://dekum.comu.edu.tr)

### Akdeniz · Sivas Cumhuriyet · Hacettepe

UNIVERSITY

Academic sea-turtle experts: Prof. Dr. Hakan Sert (Akdeniz), Prof. Dr. Bektaş Sönmez (Sivas Cumhuriyet), Prof. Ali Fuat Canbolat (Hacettepe).

🌐 [avesis.akdeniz.edu.tr/hsert](http://avesis.akdeniz.edu.tr/hsert)

🌐 [avesis.cumhuriyet.edu.tr/bsonmez](http://avesis.cumhuriyet.edu.tr/bsonmez)

## NGOS & NATIONAL ORGANISATIONS

### EKAD — Ecological Research Society

NGO

*Ekolojik Araştırmalar Derneği*

Long-standing NGO monitoring loggerhead nesting along the Antalya arc — field research, nest protection & training.

🌐 [ekad.org.tr](http://ekad.org.tr)

✉ [info@ekad.org.tr](mailto:info@ekad.org.tr)

☎ +90 530 884 3997

**Belek · Kızılot · Kumluca · Demirtaş · Tekirova**

### Kaptan June Sea Turtle Conservation Foundation

NGO

Founded by 'Captain' June Haimoff, who helped save İztuzu (Turtle Beach) from development in the 1980s.

🌐 [dalyanturtles.com](http://dalyanturtles.com)

✉ [info@dalyanturtles.com](mailto:info@dalyanturtles.com)

**Dalyan / İztuzu**

### MEDASSET

NGO

Mediterranean Association to Save the Sea Turtles — Med-wide advocacy, research & policy.

[medasset.org](https://medasset.org)

### WWF-Türkiye

NGO

*WWF International*

Habitat protection, policy and monitoring support on Türkiye's Çukurova delta beaches.

[wwf.org.tr](https://wwf.org.tr)

Akyatan · Yumurtalık · Samandağ

### DEKAFOK

NGO

Sea Turtles & Seals Protection — education & research center.

[dekafok.org.tr](https://dekafok.org.tr)

## LOCAL & COMMUNITY GROUPS

### Caretta Gazipaşa (Caretta Friends)

COMMUNITY

Local volunteers protecting loggerhead nests on Gazipaşa's beaches — marking, monitoring, hatchling guarding, excavation counts & awareness.

[carettafriends.com](https://carettafriends.com)  
[info@carettafriends.com](mailto:info@carettafriends.com)  
WhatsApp +90 501 379 4326

Gazipaşa

### Çıralı Ulupınar Environmental Cooperative

COMMUNITY

Village cooperative running Çıralı's turtle protection — a well-known community-led nesting beach with low-impact tourism.

[ulupinarkoop.org](https://ulupinarkoop.org)  
[@cirali.caretta](https://www.instagram.com/cirali.caretta)

Çıralı · Kumluca

### LİDOSK — Lykia Scouting & Nature Sports Club

COMMUNITY

Local club whose volunteers monitor and protect the Kale/Demre (Çayağzı) nesting beach.

[lidosk.org.tr](https://lidosk.org.tr)  
[info@lidosk.org.tr](mailto:info@lidosk.org.tr)  
+90 507 760 78 76

Kale (Demre)

### Anamur Sea Turtle Monitoring

COMMUNITY

*Volunteer Projects Türkiye*

Volunteer program monitoring loggerhead nests and the endangered Euphrates softshell turtle (Trionyx) around Anamur.

[gonulluprojeleri.com](https://gonulluprojeleri.com)  
[info@gonulluprojeleri.com](mailto:info@gonulluprojeleri.com)

Anamur

## OFFICIAL BODIES

### DKMP — Nature Conservation & National Parks

OFFICIAL

*Ministry of Agriculture & Forestry*

[6th Regional \(Antalya\)](#)  
[7th Regional \(Adana\)](#)

### TVK — Protection of Natural Assets

OFFICIAL

General Directorate for Protection of Natural Assets (SEPA custodian).

[tvk.csb.gov.tr](https://tvk.csb.gov.tr)